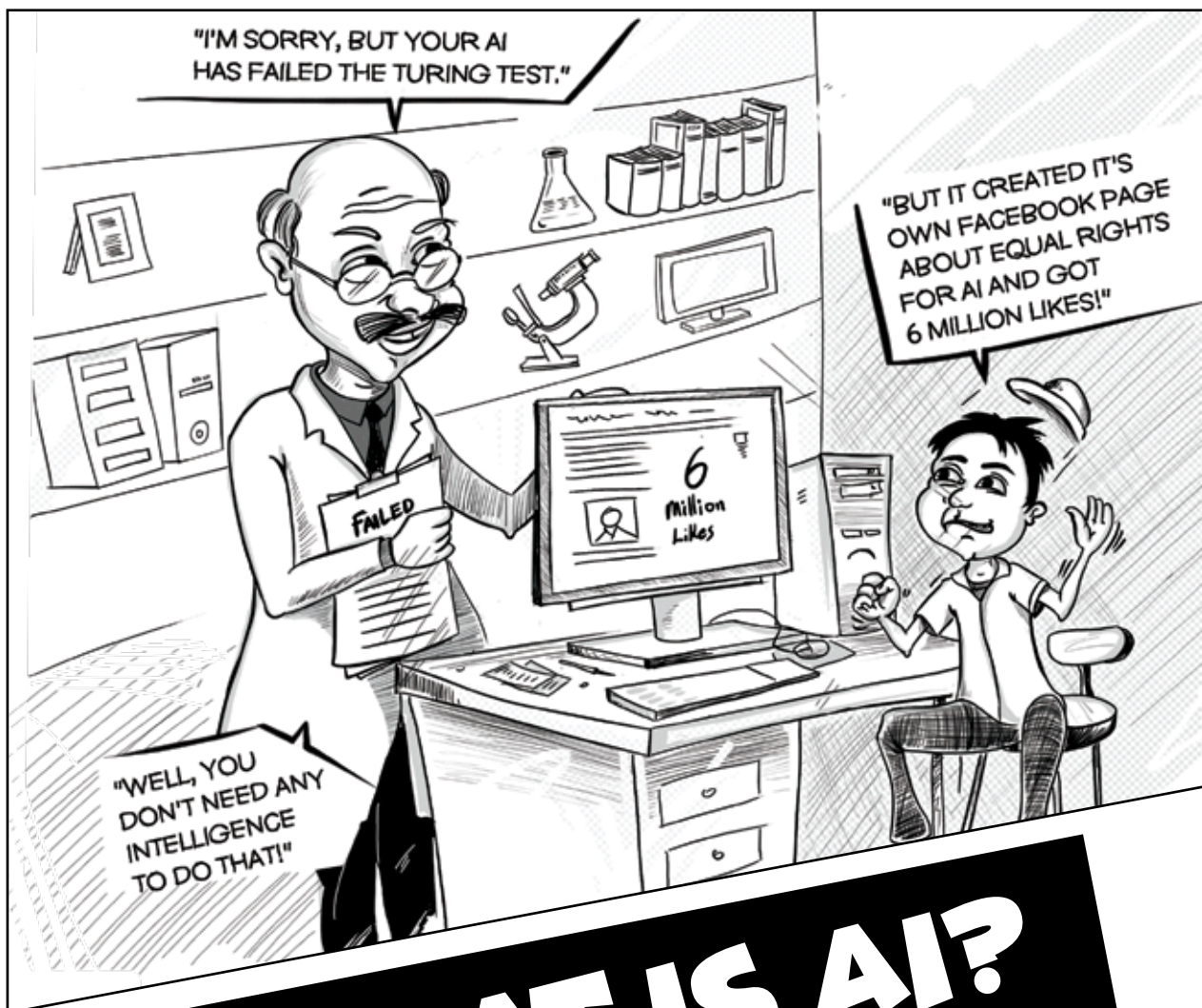




# WHAT IS AI?

CAN WE EVER AGREE ON A DEFINITION, AND IF WE CAN, IS IT SOMETHING THAT ALREADY EXISTS?

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**S**trap yourselves in, it's going to be a wild ride this year. You're going to read a whole bunch of stories about Artificial Intelligence (AI), some aimed to delight, some aimed to create despair, some will full on frighten you, while others will make you laugh out loud, and almost all of them will be bulls\*\*t. Pardon the language, but sometimes it's the only way to express the right

emotion and put things in context. Heck, some of those stories will be written by us, as we ourselves get sucked into the hype – don't blame us, we have technology fetishes to feed, and that's an expensive addiction! Take it all with a pinch of salt though.

Why? Because if the subject is cars, and people bring up everything from bicycles to jet planes, and boats to potato batteries, and claim

that it's all "cars" you'd pretty easily spot the aforementioned bulls\*\*t, I assume. It's the same thing with AI, but unlike a nice solid subject like cars, we're all fuzzy about what AI actually is.

As an experiment, I searched my inbox for the term "Artificial Intelligence", filtered out all emails sent by anyone from Digit or 9.9, and limited the search to 2017 only. What I got was 402 emails from external